Passage - 4

The Arctic's vast reserves of fossil fuel, fish and minerals are now accessible for a longer period in a year. But unlike Antarctica, which is protected from exploitation by the Antarctic Treaty framed during the Cold war and is not subject to territorial claims by any country, there is no legal regime protecting the Arctic from industrialization, especially at a time when the world craves for more and more resources. The distinct possibility of ice-free summer has prompted countries with Arctic coastline to scramble for great chunks of the melting ocean.

19. Which one of the following is the most important implication of the passage?

(a) India can have territorial claims in the Arctic territory and free acess to its resources.
(b) Melting of summer ice in the Arctic leads to changes in the geopolitics.
(c) The Arctic region will solve the world's future problem of resource crunch.
(d) The Arctic region has more resources than Antarctica.

Ans. (b) The most important implication of the above passage is option (b) according to which the melting of summer ice in the Arctic causes changes in geopolitics. In the passage the author explains that there is no legal system to protect the Arctic from industrialization, especially at a time when the world is clamoring for more and more resources. In the passage, the author makes it clear that the apparent prospect of an ice-free summer has prompted countries along the Arctic coast to scavenge for standing stretches of melting ocean.

Passage-5

Being a member of the WTO, India is bound by the agreements that have been signed and ratified by its members, including itself. According to Article 6 of the Agriculture Agreement, providing minimum support prices for agricultural products is considered distorting and is subject to limits. The subsidy arising from minimal supports cannot exceed 10 percent of the value of agricultural production for developing countries. PDS in India entails minimum support prices and public stockholding of food grains. It is possible that, in some years, the subsidy to producers will exceed 10 percent of the value of agricultural production.

20. What is the crucial message conveyed by the above passage?

(a) India should revise its PDS.
(b) India should not be a member of WTO.
(c) For India, food security collides with trade.
(d) India provides food security to its poor.

Ans. (c) In the passage food security Programme of India requires the Indian government to support farmers through MSP and distribute the procured food grains to the public through PDS. This support price should be rational this support might cross the maximum limits therefore the food security Programme of India collides with WTO agreement, is correct Answer.

Passage - 6

India's educational system is modelled on the mass education system that developed in the 19th century in Europe and later spread around the world. The goal of the system is to condition children as 'good' citizens and productive workers. This suited the industrial age that needed the constant supply of a compliant workforce with a narrow set of capabilities. Our educational institutes resemble factories with bells, uniforms and batch-processing of learners, designed to get learners to conform. But, from an economic point of view, the environment today is very different. It is a complex, volatile and globally interconnected world.

21. With reference to the above passage, the following assumptions have been made :

1. India continues to be a developing country essentially due to its faulty education system.
2. Today's learners need to acquire new-age skill-sets.
3. A good number of Indians go to some developed countries for education because the educational systems there are a perfect reflection of the societies in which they function.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b) In the passage, the need of the current world is people with entrepreneurial mindset new age skills and innovative spirit. Hence the assumption in the passage that today's learners need to acquire new age skill-sets.

Passage-7

The practice of dieting has become an epidemic; everyone is looking out for a way to attain that perfect body. We are all different with respect to our ethnicity, genetics, family history, gender, age, physical and mental and spiritual health status, lifestyles and preferences. Thereby we also differ in what foods we tolerate or are sensitive to. So we really cannot reduce so many complexities into one diet or diet book. This explains the failure of diets across the world in curbing obesity. Unless the reasons for weight gain are well understood and addressed and unless habits are changed permanently, no diet is likely to succeed.

22. What is the most, logical and rational inference that can be made from the above passage?

(a) Obesity has become an epidemic all over the world.
(b) A lot of people are obsessed with attaining a perfect body.
(c) Obesity is essentially an incurable disease.
(d) There is no perfect diet or one solution for obesity.

Ans. (d) The most logical and rational inference from the above passage is option (d). The above passage explains the failure of diets to control obesity worldwide. Unless the cause of weight gain are well understood and addressed, and unless habits are permanently changed, no diet is likely to be successful. Therefore, there is no complete diet or a solution for obesity.

Passage-8

Monoculture carries great risks. A single disease of pest can wipe out swathes of the world's food production, an alarming prospect given that its growing and wealthier population will eat 70% more by 2050. The risks are magnified by the changing climate. As the planet warms and monsoon rains intensify, farmlands in Asia will flood. North America will suffer more intense droughts, and crop diseases will spread to new latitudes.

23. Which of the following is the most logical, rational and crucial message given by the

(a) Preserving crop genetic diversity is an insurance against the effects of climate change
(b) Despite great risks, monoculture is the only way to ensure food security in the world.
(c) More and more genetically modified crops only can save the world from impending shortages of food.
(d) Asia and North America will be worst sufferers from climate change and the consequent shortage of food.

Ans. (a) The most logical, rational and crucial message of the passage in that preserving crop genetic diversity is insurance against the effects of climate change because of the great risks involved in doing a crop farming. A single disease or pest can completely destroy the lines of food production around the world.

Directions for the following 3 (three) items :
Read the following two passages and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage-1

The quest for cheap and plentiful meat has resulted in factory farms where more and more animals are squeezed into smaller lots in cruel and shocking conditions. Such practices have resulted in many of the world's health pandemics such as the avian flu. Worldwide, livestock are increasingly raised in cruel, cramped conditions, where animals spend their short live under artificial light, pumped full of antibiotics and growth hormones, until the day they are slaughtered. Meat production is water-intensive. 15000 litres of water is needed for every kilogram of meat compared with 3400 litres for rice, 3300 litres for eggs and 255 litres for a kilogram of potatoes.

24. What is the most rational and crucial message given by the passage?

(a) Mass production of meat through industrial farming is cheap and is suitable for providing protein nutrition to poor countries.
(b) Meat - producing industry violates the laws against cruelty to animals.
(c) Mass production of meat through industrial farming is undesirable and should be stopped immediately.
(d) Environmental cost of meat production is unsustainable when it is produced through industrial farming.

Ans. (d) The most rotational and crucial suspicion raised by the above passage in that the environmental cost of meat production is unsustainable when it is produced from industrial animal husbandry. As livestock rearing around the world continues to be in increasingly cruel and cramped conditions, animals spend their short lives amidst the use of artificial light, antibiotics and growth harmones, until the day of slaughter. Meat production leads to excessive consumption of water. 15000 liters of water is required for every kilogram of meat. Whereas, 3400 liters for 1 kg of paddy which shows the environmental cost of meat production.

Passage-2

A male tiger was removed from Pench Tiger Reserve and was relocated in Panna National Park. Later, this tiger trekked toward his home 250 miles away. The trek of this solitary tiger highlights a crisis. Many wildlife reserves exist as islands of fragile habitat in a vast sea of humanity, yet tigers can range over a hundred miles, seeking prey, mates and territory. Nearly one third of India's tigers live outside tiger reserves, a situation that is dangerous for both human and animal. Prey and tigers can only disperse if there are recognized corridors of land between protected areas to allow unmolested passage.

25. Which of the following is the most rational and crucial message given by the passage?

(a) The conflict between man and wildlife cannot be resolved, no matter what efforts we make.
(b) Safe wildlife corridors between protected areas is an essential aspect of conservation efforts.
(c) India needs to declare more protected areas and set up more tiger reserves.
(d) India's National Parks and Tiger Reserves need to be professionally managed.

Ans. (b) The most rational and crucial message conveyed by the above passage is that protected wildlife conservation and said that there should be valid corridors of land between the sanctuaries so that they can come without tampering.